Clishes: Stay silent stay sick; If we dont share with other people that we are going through a rought time on an inward plane then we can not get the benifit of thier help. If we think we know it all we are deluding our se lves.How can we know it all? WE need the help of the group. How can we be helped untill we request help. The answer is NO untill we ask. Remember we are surrounded by a host of loving friends who enjoy working with others. WE ALL HAVE A COMMON OBJECTIVE AND And that is recovery from addiction. We need not be shy about telling some one of an odd event that threw ous off our spiritual center.

2.Easy does it but do it. This is an evolution from the saying "easy does it: some people felt that easy does it meant that you layed arounnd or becaome ~~xxxx

NINE - JUST FOR TODAY (spiritual maintainance)

A. surrender

B. one day at a time

C. the thing we do each day

D. first things first

E. easy does it

F. other cliches

G. sharing

H. vulnerability

I. choices & options

J. prayer and meditation

K. SERVICE SELFLESS

L. wisdom

M. serenity

N. learning (to listen, etc.)

O. daily reprieve based on practical spirituality

TEN - MORE WILL BE REVEALED

A. the changing nature of addiction

B. environment of recovery

C. self-revelation and we are introduced to ourselves

D. self adjusting

E. openmindedness

ELEVEN - STORIES

APPENDIX

#9 A - SURRENDER (1)

0057 -22-

progress and adding to it. Whenever we are in trouble with ourselves, we can learn to relate the difficulty to one of the steps and get a great deal of control over our lives. Ongoing cleanliness will reveal to us other defects which we will be able to deal with as they come. Remember when we stop fighting old battles we win in the present. Usually by now the need to compulsively defend our point of view and never admit to fault will have left us to a great extent. if we have trouble admitting our faults when they occur we should be willing to practice a little and see what happens. Surprisingly most people who would otherwise have gone to great lengths to show us our fault are usually completly disarmed and confused when we suddenly say we're sorry. Often they are suspicious and wonder what's up! They may even really blow our minds and admitt that they wern't all that right themselves. At any rate it's well worth looking into. Take your results to a meeting and share them. It will usually be humorous or profound.

#9 A- SURRENDER (2)

GOD'S WILL FOR ME

God's will for me is to take advantage of God's grace by asking him for it. If you ask God for grace, He will give you the strength to do His will. His will is to do what is best for you and others at the same time, to live in harmony with other people and with the universe, to stay clean and sober by going to any lengths, (such as service, exercise, working the steps, going to meetings, growing, praying for God's grace, and meditating in order to have communion with Him), to do what is best for me and others at all times, and at the same time by asking Him for relief from bondage to the self, to let Him build with ~~me~~ me and do with ~~me~~ me as He will.

If our surrender to our disease is complete, the rest of our recovery is dependent on our belief in a Loving God of our own understanding who cares for us and will do for us what we found impossible alone. Remember, as a recovering addict our fellow members love us and cannot fail to respond to our sincere desire for help. We believe God works the same way.

What a change from how I used to be. That's how I know the NA program works. It's the first thing that ever convinced me I needed to change myself instead of trying to change oth[illegible] the people and situations that irritated me. And then it gave me a 12 step blueprint for doing just that.

0075

Resentments can deaden our spirits and get us loaded again but they can also be very useful once we learn to acknowledge them and then put them in their pro-

place, in the hands of our Higher Power.

9-A

your new found way of life will have problems. If you ask for help the road ahead won't be so rocky. Sometimes in your opinion no one can handle your most recent problems That is when we turn it over to God. After we turn it over to God we sometimes take it back, try to do it ourselves, and repeat the whole process one again.

The principles of surrender, admission of responsibility when we are at fault, improving faith, prayer and meditation guide us into a way of life in which all our resources, centered in God as we understand God, become available to us. 0058

If our surrender to our disease is complete, the rest of our recovery is dependant on our belief in a loving God of our own understanding who cares for us and will do for us what we found impossible to do by ourselves. Remember, as a recovering addict our fellow members love us and cannot fail to respond to our sincere desire for help. We believe God works the same way. He does in our lives when we ask Him.

(4)

#9 - A SURRENDER

We come from every walk of life. We may be middle aged, professionals; we are also teenagers, housewives, street junkies and college students. The details of our lives cover the entire spectrum of possible life styles; we are of all creeds, races and religions.

0058

What we have in common, what we have all felt, is the aloness, separatness, misery and despair, the pain inside us, is the empty numbness that set us apart from our fellows. The one thing we all share, the uniting factor, is that we all felt we were unique, different, better than or worse than, but always separate or separated — We had a very empty place inside us. We felt we were alone. Our pain surrounded us, but didn't fill the empty place inside us.

(22)

Change involves the unknown and requires courage in areas that really matter. The same Higher Power that has helped us deal with our compulsion to use will be our source of c urage whenever we ask for it. The wisdom to know the difference involves growth on the program. Most of us just seem to know what to do or avoid doing in areas that used to defeat us. This knowledge usually comes after we have removed self will from the picture through our willingness.

54

Maintaining Our Spiritual Condition

Among those of us who have been clean and sober for a number of twenty-four hours, we find there are some guidelines we all follow and a similarity in the pattern of our recovery; as there was a similar or universal pattern to the separatness, aloness, self-hatred and despair which characterized our active addiction.

A 9 - A Surr...

(5)

The principles of surrender, admission of responsibility When we are at fault, improving faith, prayer and meditation guide us into a way of life in which all our resources, centered in God as we understand God, become available to us.

I am now able to accept change as the hand of God in my life. It is a natural and primary result of recovery in Narcotics Anonymous. I have been granted relief from pain in countless ways. I feel a part of you people. I have learned a new point of view that seemed impossible before coming to the program with surrender in my heart. I have learned that I have to keep doing th ings to keep changing for the better or it will get old and I might take my miraculous new life for granted and fall back into the horror of my addiction.

0142

IT WAS A HUMBLING EXPERIENCE. HOW LONG HAD I SOUGHT FOR AN ~~ANGER~~ ANSWER, AND BEEN GIVEN ONE - BY THE GRACE OF GOD! HOW MANY TIMES AFTER COMMING INTO THE PROGRAM HAD I TAKEN THINGS INTO MY HANDS ONLY TO END UP IN THE END ASKING GOD TO TO FOR ME WHAT I COULDN'T DO. HOW MANY TIMES HAD I LOOKED AT A JOB WELL DONE AND SAID SEE WHAT A GOOD JOB I CAN DO? FORGETTING WHERE THE ABILITY CAME FROM!

0160

The fine art of expressing a resentment to a person who has offended us begins with our accepting personal responsibility for taking offense. Sometimes the wisest way to deal with an intolerable person or situation is just to leave. If we are to deal with our difficulties clean, we must put our cleanliness ahead of every other person, place or thing. A threat to our cleanlinessis a threat to our lives. How often have we seen a person die after using a petty resentment as an excuse to use again. Resentments usually come with a spiritually weakened condition. Happy people don't get angry as often. Remember that this is a save your own life program. No one can get me clean or make me ~~stay~~ except myself. We most often resent behavior in others that we see and fear in our selves. That is why we can feel so good when we let ourselves forgive someone who has wronged us. In reality we are forgiving ourselves through the other person. We ask ourselves, "Is there anything I can do to change my situation for the better or should I leave it alone"?

If you are like us, drugs and alcohol may have worked for a time, but finally they failed us too. Religion and psychiatry had no answers for us that we could use. Jails, institutions and death didn't hold as much terror for us as continuing to live with the unabating misery, lonliness and pain of our addiction.

#9 B ONE DAY AT A TIME (6)

An opinion

With our higher power guiding us, we may never again have to deal using, but we will always have to deal with staying clean & sober everyday.

My name is David E., today I am a recovering addict. I have an addiction problem to both alcohol & drugs. I will have this problem til the day I die, tomorrow well I can't say, for in my program of recovery there is no tomorrow, no yesterday, only today. I find that for me this is an extremely positive course of action for me to follow.

Through N.A. & living my life one day at a time, I do not learn how to handle my addiction, but how to handle my sobriety. It wasn't really that hard for me to stop using, the hard part was to stay stopped. Through N.A. & my higher power & friend a road that was suggested that I travel on. I find that after I travel for 24 hours I start to get tired, and if I try to travel another day without taking the time out to express my gratitude to my higher power for helping me help myself, I start stinking thinking. A lot happens in one day for me, both negative & positive, & if I don't take the time to appreciate both, chances are I will miss something that will help me grow, possibly cause me to get loaded. The big book of A.A. says something that I can really relate to, We cast off the burdens of the past and the anxieties of the future, as we begin to live in the present, one day at a time. We are granted the serenity to accept the thing we cannot change, & thus lose our quickness to anger & sensitivity to criticism. I have to live my program, which is my life, one day at a time. If I don't I'll start worring about things that when they happen I find out they weren't worth worring about & with all that worrying I don't have time to fully work my program, & that for me brother & sister could be a deadly mistake.

LIVE DAVID

AG-6 ONE DAY AT A TIME

(7)

(9)

ONE DAY AT A TIME

0157

Concern yourself with present tense,...Forget about the past...Who knows what the future brings...Or how long it will last....The hour at hand is all that counts...Tomorrow's another day...Try 24 hours at a time...It's easier that way ...You cannot change tomorrow's fate...Yesterday's past and gone...Friends and families help a lot...You won't survive alone...If you try real hard and concentrate...On one day at a time...Your day will end with no regrets...And that's the very best kind...What have you done...And what will come...Are thoughts that trouble your mind...But life is priceless...If you live it...Just one day at a time...

james h.

If you haven't accomplished anything but stay straight a sober all ~~sobers~~-day-you've accomplished a miracle

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

Did you ever stop to think what a new day means? We wake up each morning to find that a new day has been placed in our hands...to do with what we want. It is a precious gift. The new day is like a fresh clean piece of paper upon which we can record what we do. Yesterday is a soiled page, where we have messed up badly, and is a thing of the past that can be discarded. Those hours before dawn, even a great deal of the night, may have been a nightmare because of any troubled thoughts, worries or pains, but once more, with a new day, we have a fresh spotless morning, and as a Psalmist said, " Joy comes with the morning." A new day is a wonderful miracle happening which God performs for us every twenty-four hours. We must realize and appreciate this, not merely take it for granted, as we are too likely to do with many of our blessings! Thoreau suggested that " The dawn is when I am awake and there is a 'sunrise' in me." We would all do well to establish the habit of awakening in that same manner. It would help us to start the day well.

He stressed that going to meetings, working the twelve steps and practicing these principles in his life, remembering to ask God for help in the morning and to thank Him at night, only worked for one day. That the next morning he couldn't get up and say, 'well, I did all these things yesterday. I don't have to do them again today.' Rather, that he had a continuing and progressive illness and that he is granted only a daily reprieve.

That on those days he doesn't work the Steps, go to meetings etc., he doesn't have a good day. Sometimes after a few days of not doing anything to maintain his spiritual condition he has a really lousy day

9-B - ONE DAY AT A TIME (8)

THE TWENTY-FOUR HOUR PROGRAM

Look to this day!
For it is life, the very life of life.
In its brief course lie all the verities
and realities of one's existence:
The bliss of growth,
The glory of action,
The splendor of beauty.
For yesterday is but a dream
and tomorrow only a vision.
But today, well lived, makes
Every yesterday a dream of happiness,
And every tomorrow a vision of hope.
Look well, therefore, to this day.
Such is the salutation of the dawn.

From the Sanskrit.

RALPH

[illegible] stand on the base of it. [illegible] is incomprehensible. But if you take it one step at a time, it can climb it.

0157

If we set unachievable goals, we stage our own failure. If we put ourselves first and remember that we're more important than any person, place or thing that would threaten our sobrietyx then we'll keep it simple. Don't worry too much about things that might happen but just live and let live and keep it a day at a time until we can give them other fellow the right to be wrong. When things go well, don't go out and celebrate and when things go bad, remember that this to will pass. A meeting a day, getting and using phone numbers and reading literature a little a day are good forms of insurance for Sobriety. It has been said that no one who has asked their H.P. for help in the morning meditation has gotten dirty that day. There might be exceptions but I don't know any. Practice accepting help. Practice giving help. When you can feel the program beginning to work, don't freak out. Personality change is a natural progression set in motion by your surrender to the program. The tools are the sayings that seemed to help us most when we came in. They xxxxxxx apply to the little , dangerous, daily situations that seem so heavy when we come in. When we use them, ~~it is~~

[illegible] WITH RIGHT TO EXISTENCE [illegible]

#9-B-ONE DAY AT A TIME (9)

THOUGHT FOR THE DAY

0157

I have hope. That magic thing that I had lost or misplaced. The future looks dark no more. I do not even look at it, except when necessary to make plans. I try to let the future take care of itself. The future will be made up of todays and todays, stretching out as short an now and as long as eternity. Hope is justified by many right nows, by the rightness of the present. Nothing can happen to me that God does not will for me. I can hope for the best, as long as I have what I have and it is good.

****

The pain in the neck you complain about may be the result of looking backward.

****

Each day I try to Let Go and Let God, Keep an Open Mind, to Live and Let Live and to keep on taking my own inventory and work on me. My addict still has his problems but I have found the emotional stability I so badly needed and the freedom and serenity and happiness I so badly wanted.

9-C

Before going to sleep we take a few moments to thank our Higher Power for keeping us clean that day and for helping us with our living problems. Reliance on a power greater than ourselves, is the foundation of all our recovery.

0054

Each day a goal is set. I set this goal to learn something new about myself everyday. I find that I can use serenity as a tool in my everyday living.

0101

JUST FOR TODAY

Just for to-day I will try to live through this day only, and not tackle my whole life problem at once. I can do something for twelve hours that would appall me if I felt that I had to keep it up for a lifetime.

Just for to-day I will be happy. This assumes to be true what Abraham Lincoln said, that "Most folks are as happy as they make up their minds to be".

Just for to-day I will adjust myself to what is, and not try to adjust everything to my own desires. I will take my "luck" as it comes, and fit myself to it.

Just for to-day I will try to strengthen my mind. I will study. I will learn something useful. I will not be a mental loafer. I will read something that requires effort, thought and concentration.

Just for to-day I will exercise my soul in three ways: I will do somebody a good turn, and not get found out: if anybody knows of it, it will not count. I will do at least two things I don't want to do—just for exercise. I will not show anyone that my feelings are hurt; they may be hurt, but to-day I will not show it.

Just for to-day I will be agreeable. I will look as well as I can, dress becomingly, talk low, act courteously, criticize not one bit, not find fault with anything, and not try to improve or regulate anybody but myself.

Just for to-day I will have a programme. I may not follow it exactly, but I will have it. I will save myself from two pests; hurry and indecision.

Just for to-day I will have a quiet half hour all by myself, and relax. During this half hour, sometime, I will try to get a better perspective of my life.

Just for to-day I will be unafraid. Especially I will not be afraid to enjoy what is beautiful, and to believe that as I give to the world, so the world will give to me.

#9-D First Things First

~~Spiritual advisor~~. Again, the only time we can remove the problem is when we stop drinking & using the problem around with to help the Atomic that are necessary to remove the problem. ~~So consider sometimes thereby~~

9-D

The starter kit of gratitude may be found in the Fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous. The tools we use now are the 12-Steps of the N.A program.

#9-E EASY DOES IT

For me happiness is first changing your mind. If you can't solve a problem right now don't worry about it. Don't worry about what might happen. It might not. Live in the here and now. Put one foot in front of the other & as they say (~~and~~) not regret the past nor fear the future. Live one day at a time and enjoy it.

0036

What are you going to do when you have to face your first crises? When the time comes we hope you will be well equipted with the tools and the principles of the program of Narcotics Anonymous. The enemy we have to fight is our own self-destructiveness. When we begin to work the program, wexi will like ourselves better and much of the lonliness and fear will have been replaced by the love of the fellowship and the security of being a part of a new way of life. It is important to remember easy does it.

0059

#9-f Other Cliches

(13)

#0059

Living clean and sober a day at a time will reveal to us the things that truly come from withinand give us power over things that would interrupt our flow. If we don't try something new, within the program of Narcotics Anonymous, we will be limited to variations on old themes. Surely we've had enough of that. In accord with our pamplet we should keep an ppen mind about spiritual principals. Patience, humility and tolerance are qualities well worththe high price we must pay for them. The one that concerns us here is humility. The most important definition of humility is freedom from pride and arrogance. With the new skills and abilities given us by the program, the need for false pride is canceled out. Arrogance, the sick need to dominate others, diminishes until we are a comfortable part of the human family again. It is important, I think, to be gentle with ourselves when we are setting the ego to rest. It has served us well by keeping us out of situations that we could not handle. We are not exposing ourselves to any real dangers when we lower our old defenses. The defense mechanisms were aquired in our using days and served a real need back then. In the new lives begun in the fellowship, many if not all of the old dangers have ceased to be. Our senses are sharper and a lot more reliable than when we were operating. The reactions we have to our envirionment become more accurate and we will be able to count on them. If we feel upthight, we will probably have good reason to. We will also be able to deal with difficulty better. Our new friends will help us, particularly when asked. Their experience, strength and hope is like a great storehouse

#9-F- Other Clichés (FF)

Reddin of Personality are possible and happening all around us. With God all things are possible.

Can't keep anything until you give it away.

Loving the unlovable they loved me when I was unlovable.

Emotional zombie couldn't feel anything. Grateful I can feel now.

Why would I help somebody else because God has been so good to me.

#9-F - Others' Cliches (15)

QUOTES FROM OTHER SOURCES

When you stretch the truth, watch for the snapback.....@@@@@@@@@@

A person who talks about his inferiors, have none.....@@@@@@@@@

When looking for faults use a mirror not a telescope.....@@@@@@@@@

One minute of being tolerant could prevent hours of being miserable.....@@@@@@@@@

Don't look down another person unless you're bending over to help him...@@@@@@@@@

The trouble with thee is often me.....@@@@@@@@@

Let us not pass judgement on anyone who does not keep step withus. He marches to a different set of drums. Each man marches to his own music.....@@@@@@@@@@

The biggest problem in the world could have beeen solved when it was small.@@@@@@

SIX STATES OF DRUNKENESS

9

(1) dry and decent
(2) delighted and devilish
(3) dizzy and delirious
(4) dazed and dejected
(5) dead drunk
(6) DEAD

The world is full of willing people; some are willing to work and some are willing .....to let them.....

Do all the good you can to all the people you can in all the ways you can by all the means you can as long as you can.....;;;;;;;;;;;;

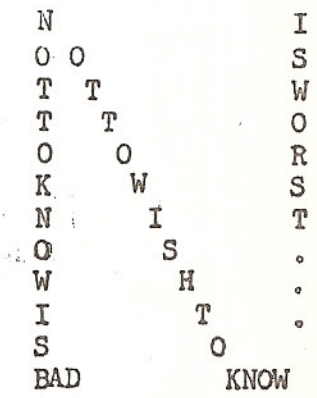
Hidden from the world we willmake love
Hidden from others, we can make love
But hidden from ourselves, we have no love.....

Today we are becoming what we will be tomorrow.....

****

A PRISONER'S PRAYER

Through the past and dreadful years
My eyes, they've shed unnumbered tears
Although I've tried without success
I am steadily amounting to less and less
But if God grant me just one wish
The one I'd choose would go like this
Oh, God above, give me the aid to right
The wrongs that I have.....made
Give me the strength to carry on
And find the life for which I love.....



If I can learn to live each day...As though it were my last...To use each fleeting thoughtfor good and forgpt about the past...To place my cares on God alone.....
From now through eternity...It is by faith....We find true serenity.....

#9 -F- OTHER Cliches

IF WE ~~TO~~ DO FOR OTHERS FOR OWN ~~GRATIFICATION~~ GLORY, NOTHING WE SAY OR DO HAS MEANING

IF I GIVE NO MERCY, HOW CAN I EXPECT TO RECIEVE MERCY

THE ONLY FOOLISH WORDS WE SAY ARE THOSE WE SAY BEFORE THINKING

THE ONLY STUPID QUESTIONS ARE THOSE WE ASK AND THEN DONT LISTEN TO THE ANSWERS

A MAN HEARS WHAT HE WANTS TO HEAR AND DISREGARDS THE REST, AND FOR THAT ~~REASON~~ REASON WE OFTEN MISS WHAT IS BEING SAID

NOTHING CAN BE ACCOMPLISHED ABOUT WHAT IS WRONG UNTILL WE ARE WILLING TO DO SOMETHING ABOUT IT

#9-F- OTHER CLICHES (17)

From Bondage to Spiritual Faith

From Spiritual Faith to Great Courage

From Great Courage to Liberty

From Liberty to Abundance

From Abundance to Selfishness 0079

From Selfishness to Complacency

From Complacency to Apathy

From Apathy to Dependency

From Dependency to Bondage

Yesterday is a canceled check; tomorrow is a promissory note; today is ready cash— use it.

Faith doesn't spring out of feeling (good) feeling springs from faith in God.

I will strive for happiness as my goal and accept the courage to change. 0101

0157

PROVERBS

KNOWLEDGE IS LIKE A GARDEN: IF IT IS NOT CULTIVATED, IT CANNOT BE HARVESTED

IF A DEAD TREE FALLS, IT CARRIES A LIVE ONE WITH IT

HEARTS DO NOT MEET ONE ANOTHER LIKE ROADS

TO BE WITHOUT A FRIEND, IS TO BE POOR, INDEED

WE START AS FOOLS AND BECOME WISE THROUGH EXPERIENCE

INDECISION IS LIKE A STEP CHILD; IF H E DOESN'T WASH HIS HANDS, HE IS CALLED DIRTY, IF HE DOES, HE IS WASTING WATER

SORROW IS LIKE A PRECIOUS TREASURE, SHOWN ONLY TO FRIENDS

IF YOU TRY TO CLEANSE OTHERS LIKE SOAP, YOU WILL AWAY IN THE PROCESS

NO MATTER HOW LONG THE NIGHT, DAY IS SURE TO COME

THOSE WHO ARE ALWAYS ABSENT ARE ALWAYS WRONG

EVIL ENTERS LIKE A NEEDLE AND SPREADS LIKE AN OAK TREE

#9

Indifference or intolerance toward spiritual principles will defeat us in our recovery. We become open minded in proportion to the sincerity of our desire for recovery.

#9

G.

(18)

The fellowship after a meeting is a good opportunity to come out with things we didn't get to share at the meeting. It is also a good time to share on a one-on-one with our sponsors or someone we sponsor. When we talk freely about our question and answers, many parts of our message surface for the first time or become clearer to us. 0048

Helping others is one way we maintain our spiritual condition and stay safe from relapse. The program is what we make it. Those of us who failed sufficiently at living to maintain our humility are really fortunate. Among those of us the desire for recovery is stronger and we are willing to go to greater lengths to get it. When we find a brother or sister who is in pain, we have more insight into the problems of self-will run riot. We can more often see a way out that is acceptable to the suffering addict.

0048

We all find that the feeling we get from helping others motivates us to do better in our own lives. If we are hurting, and most of us do from time to time, we learn to ask for help. We find that pain shared is pain lessened.

, relationships are great as long as weare in them to help and not to hurt our spiritual condition on which our not taking that first pill, fix, or drink hangs on which our lives depend. BUT to pack what we can into the steam oflife. Do be honest promptly , openedminded, for they lead tohumility and tolerance, not self deceit, and willing to try for it leads to patience. THink well of your partnner under no condition are we to live in an angery or hostile mood ;under the anger is faer Which is lack of faith. Take the venture of faith .what have you got to lose? 0044

#9

G.

. That only through working all the steps, continuing to attend meetings, daily meditation, using all the tools of the program, and with the help of his Higher Power does he maintain his spiritual condition. Then and only then he has something to share with others. 0046

Sometimes, he said, he sees his Higher Power working through other people. That sometimes when an old-timer gets away from steps, daily prayer and meditation, and isn't working the program to the best of his ability on a daily basis, that other members see that old-timer hurting. Just as the newcomer is the most important person at any meeting, the old-timer who is hurting, is like that newcomer, the person it is most important we reach out to.

Mistrust across to tear it down only by trust can we enjoy the person for who they are 0044

Understanding walks hand-in-hand in communication, understanding the persons feeling, wants, their needs, likes & dislikes. Many times in a relationship One or the other seem to be out of sorts at times they may be grumpy, silent, depressed moody or at the other extreme unusually excited hyper & even ("crazy"). It takes understanding of who the person is to deal with this at all times, good bad or indifferent be understanding

the corner stone to the destruction of the relationship.

Honesty: In all phases of the relationship we should remain thourghly honest. Only in honesty can each partner be respected. ~~Honesty w/ feelings~~ If we aren't honest in our feelings, how can we expect a full & lasting ~~Act~~ relationship

Individuality: at all costs, each partner should allow the other to remain themselves. In being human we all have our goals that we reach for. If ~~those~~ these goals are smothered or taken away! We retaliate at worse we loose a part of ourselves. This can lead only to destruction of the person & the relationship. In what ways does Individuality aid the relationship? Each person being free to make their own choices more truly gives. This is another part of a relationship. Giving, recieving & giving more.

Caring: To care for the person you who they are, not what they are or what they may have to offer is a great & glorious phase of love. Caring is something we can't do enough of in the relationship.

Trust: There must be absolute trust for a good relation. Trust is one of the great steps in a relationship. Jealousy seems to be the single largest contributor to mistrust. Trust says: To give the relationship to grow

9-H Vulnerability

(21)

Any drug addict clean and sober without a compulsion to use is a miracle. We keep this miracle alive in on going recovery with attitudes and awarenesses involving personal Growth. When we find ourselves in trouble with our recovery, after some time ~~on the program~~ clean and sober, we have usually stopped doing one or more of the things which helped us in the earlier stages of our recovery. This lack of daily maintenance can show up

0058

As our lives become more comfortable, many of us lapse into spiritual complacency and we find ourselves in the same horror and loss of purpose from which we came. We forget we are given only a daily reprieve. We must ask for help each morning and remember to thank our Higher Power at night, if we don't maintain

0058

As our lives become more comfortable, many of us lapse into spiritual complacency and we find ourselves in the same horror and loss of purpose from which we came. We forget we are given only a daily reprieve. We must ask for help each morning and remember to thank our Higher Power at night, if we don't maintain our spiritual condition daily, some of us find the resulting pain and confusion lead to a return to drugs and our old way of life. Many have made it back from such slips. Many have not.

Through our experience, we have found that through carrying out our negative thoughts, we hurt ourselves most of all. How many times have we felt, "I'll get you, I'll get loaded!"? Why should we let someones negative actions control our tendency toward good behavior. Fighters die and we don't recover by getting even.

It is easy for some of us to lapse into spiritual complacency as our lives become more comfortable. Unless we maintain our spiritual condition we lapse into the same horror and loss of purpose from which we came. Helping others is the surest way of maintaining our spiritual condition safe from relapse.

#9-I Choices & Options

(22)

These are guidelines and suggestions. We have found they work for us. This is how we maintain our spiritual condition. For us this finally fills the empty place. We never have to be lonely again. Our Higher Power is accessable at all times, night and day, and in the fellowship of Narcotics Anonymous we have more friends than we ever believed we could. Finally, we are fulfilled, unlonely and come to know a real peace and a true sense of self-worth.

We continue making plenty of meetings throughout all phases of our recovery. We also as part of our spiritual maintainence take a part in active service. Some of us find becoming active in service work provides us with a way to be ofhelp in providing for the needs of our groups and membership, which cannot be met by individual members. We find service work an experience in putting principles before personalities, and a growing and learning where we strive to put into practice the principles and traditions of our program. Most of us who have become involved have found that unselfish service to the program returns more to us than we give.

The obcessiveness is really common to all the addicts Ivve met or heard of... Like a guy will get a scene or a rap going that will be like his cloak when his life is used up. The things he talks about when he has no real life left. Obcessions drive addicts past the normal human limits and many times wins them great fame of recognition-- until they burn out. The drug induced states can allow a person to exclude all the normal background awareness and focus entirely on a single point. At first this can be like a handy magnifying glass used at will. Later it ca n become a horrible sequence of all-consuming bits and pieces that rush up continually and we find ourselves powerless to control what's happening to us. Speed is definitely obcessive. Downs can relieve some of the pains of obcessions and become the ultimate obcession. Obcessions are like mental spasms. The mind xunsintu am draws up like a spastic muscle. It shorts out and ceases to function normally. The subconcious mind is free to act.

Honesty,,openmindedness and the willingness to try are three principles which will guide us in recovery ir we learn to use them. Often we fall short but the times that we suceed, clean and sober, reveal a new experience of life. We no longer need to make excuses or cover up who we are or what we are. New ideas become available to us often for the first time.

#9-I

(23)

Changing one's habits is not an easy task, as anyone who has tried doing so knows. There's a certain old gaelic proverb that states, " We establish many habits,"A twist in an old stick is not easily straightened.", over a period of time and finally, if we know that we are not commendable, we decide to alter them and find this is much easier said than done. There are four excellent rules that if followed, will help greatly in changing our habits. First take a positive, never a negative attitude. Second, try very hard to avoid any exceptions, as even one can mean a down fall. The third rule is to find a worthy substitute for the habit you are trying to discard. It will be a great help. In seeking to replace many old habits with new and better ones, nothing can help as much as this.

00599-I

Drug addicts are keenly aware of the difference between right and wrong . Many persons with our disease are convinced they are right and the world is wrong and use this belief to justify their self destructive behavior. A person with our disease developes and maintains a losers point of view which enables them to pursue their addiction without the the restraints of concern with their own well being. Simply put, the losers point of view focuses on the negative in all

We continue making plenty of meetings to maintain our spiritual condition. Getting active in service helps us provide for these needs of groups and members which cannot be met by the individual meetings. Most of us have found that unselfish service to the program returns more than we are able to give. Helping out with the functions of the meetings adds to our recovery by giving us something tangible to do to help. Helping build tthe service structure in your area is only an extension of coffee chairman type duties. Many of us believe t that personal service is the most rewarding in spiritual terms. Personal service is taking an active interest in the recovery of another addict. Anything we do or say to help them, helps us maintain our spiritual condition in a way that protects us from danger of relapse.

* the serenity prayer embodies the guiding principles of change which grant us recovery. Accepting things we cannot change relieves us of fighting losing battles. This frees us to direct our energies into more useful channels. More than that acceptance can become an active principle in dealing with the many people, places and things beyond our control. Acceptance is something we can do where nothing else is possible. *

-2-

Pain shared is pain lessened. Few of us could survive without learning to deal with difficulty clean and sober. We seek this help from our literature, from each other, from the meetings, from our sponsor and most of all from the God of our understanding.

#9-I

(24)

When we forgive the shortcomings of another person, we recieve the benefits of that forgiveness. By using the resources of the program of Narcotics Anonymous - a sponsor, a friend in the program or a meeting - we don't have to waste time dwelling on negative feelings. Setting another person straight often has self-destructive effects. If only we could see our own defects as clearly as we see them in others!

Justified resentments are especially dangerous. When we have actually been injured by another, we should deal with our situation openly and honestly rather than internalizing our anger and creating a resentment. Bottled up anger can produce a live steam effect that causes us to explode in uncontrolled agression. In other words, don't hold a resentment inside where it can grow. Talk to your sponsor or someone in the program with whom you are close or take it to a meeting without mentioning names if you feel you cannot directly approach the p person against whom you hold the resentment. By doing this you get past the hostility generated by the resentment and into the solution. The sooner we can get our reactions back under our own control, the better for us.

At one time or another during our addiction most of us have been in a very desperate situation and experienced a state where we were able to survive by quickly doing and saying the right thing until the danger passed. Many of us tried to maintain this feeling of adequacy and failed. The same inner force that saved our lives on so many occassions becomes available to us in our recovery. We learn how to bring out this inner force many of us call God and to apply it in our daily lives. Our Twelve Steps guide us to contact with this spiritual force and it meets all our needs.

4 Resentments can sometimes be barometers of my growth too. If someone suggests to me that I might get better results by doing something a little

We are wired into the seat of the universe and a force greater than ourselve this force can be our best friend or seem like our worst enemy. We have the power to choose which it will be.

#9-I

0044 (25)

January 20, 1980

Spiritual Relationships

In recovery we strive to learn and apply spiritual valeus to our lives. We develop the unseen side of ourselves and it makes a big difference in the life we live. In relating with o pthers, spiritual values lead to spiritual relationships. In other words when we got to the program we could relate along physical lines or mental but the spiritual or emotional would always go on. People who got close to us could see the negativety, dishonesty and selfishness. Only a person with a need for misery would want to get involved with us. We come in takers and learn to be givers. A lot of us regarded ourselves as generous but we usually expected specific returns. Love is a genuine interest in and caring for another without thought of getting anything in return.

Expectations put a pricetag on love. In a spiritual relationship we learn to feed one another fellings and insights that allow us to expand the World we live in. Fear, guilt and hate contract our our living experience. Our fellowship teaches us to seek our own answers rather than follow a set formula which may or may not apply to our situation. When a relationship becomes more important than maintaining our spiritual condition, we seem to fall into our old ways. Developing our own patience, tolerance and humility seems to make us fit to accept another human being as they are. Fear of loss of control has prompted us change others to conform to our expectations and this usually leads to extreme discomfort for the other person. As we learn to take better care of ourselves, we can be easier on others. Humility makes it easier for others to enjoy our company and feel at ease. Fault finding and self seeking has a way of destroying this ease of feeling.

We are not trying to tell anyone what to do in this pamphlet. We are concerned because a lot of our members have sought relationships as a sort of ultimate answer. Romantic attactments and the pleasurable sensations we can get from a member of the opposite sex can obscure spiritual goals. We can get a regular mood change from such a relationship. In growing spiritually we can find more, much more, from learning to reach the deeper levels in others. Love increases the number of people we can say hello to, care about, and deepens the feelings we can have for one another. Hate is love shut off. Indifferance isolates us and reduces the number of people we can get along with and shutts us off from others. Some may even feel that they have to limit the number and depth of their relationships because they can handle too much. We think that's fine. What What we're trying to share is that in growing along spiritual lines we can have and enjoy more than the old life had to offer.

Meetings and good fellowship give us more spiritually and we naturally have more to offer others. Working the 12 Steps give us a closer feeling with our Higher Power and relieve us of defects and unmade ammends that used to have us in their grip. When we look for the God in something we find the good. When we look for the good in something we find the God. Some of us have found that if we pray before conversing with another, that only the God consciousness within us thouch the other person,

#9-J Prayer and meditation

(26)

Many (2nd W) Establishing a daily contact with a higher power. It is not important who or what this higher power is but that one have one. For some addicts this power is the Group, or their sponsor or some cosmic force as many find it. Organized religion has no place in this program. We practice spiritual principles that if you find your higher power with organized religion

Many of us practice some form of daily meditation and include reading material of a spiritual nature that reminds us of our disease and offers different points of view to revitalize our living. We suggest you find what works for you. 0056

The "12 Step" plan is the finest basic self-help approach with which I am familiar. Since it is good "common sense," the thoughts can be applied by religious believer and non-believer alike. The "12 Step" plan is a tried and true method of restoring meaning and sanity to one's life. If I may be of any help to an N.A. member with any of his "steps" along the way, I would be happy to serve. An understanding on the part of one's wife and/or family outside is likewise an important aspect of a person's progress on this N.A. program. Again, if we can be of assistance, I would like to rap with the interested readers that we can. Usually I am around the institution on every day but Wednesdays and Thursdays. However the least time to rap a while is on Saturday or Sunday afternoon. At any rate, I would like to encourage you to give yourself and your Creator a chance. Life IS worth living. If you know where you are GOING!!!! 0157

#9-I

(27)

Before going to bed we can thank our Higher Power for keeping us clean and sober that day and helping us with our living problems. Reliance on a power, greater than ourselves, is the foundation of all our recovery. Some rely on for you use the groups, but whatever works, use it. Before the program most of us looked to God through prayer when all else failed. In recovery we try to build some form of pfayer and meditation into our daily routines. The results are truly amazing. We also try to pray in gratitude. This seems to help our conscious contact and make it more co fortable.

We don't have to plead bargain for Divine intercession ie, I won't use drugs today if You . . .

9 0026 Steps

0036

Normal living is possible as human beings when we rely on a higher power on a daily basis to provide us spiritual progress.

The 12-Steps of Narcotics Anonymous are a progressive recovery process establishing in us normal living; the normal life of reliance in our Higher Power.

The reliance on a higher power is possible because we no longer have a chemical separating our consciousness from higher power consciousness.

Chemicals act as a roadblock to higher power consciousness, thus causing the hopeless and helpless feeling of inadequacy most using drug addicts experience as a result of this separation.

We are going to feel inadequate as long as there is a mood changing or mind altering chemical in our body; it is the result of long term drug usage, though the eventual remorse can occur at any stage in the disease.

our recovery is dependent on our belief in a loving God who cares for us and will do for us whatever we found impossible by ourselves. Remember, your fellow members love you and cannot fail to respond to your sincere desire for help. God works the same way. He has for us, As a recovering addict and if you ask Him, He will for you do.

#9-J

(28)

PRAYERS

God, manage my life for me. May I let you always do this for me one day at a time so that I may serve others and better do Thy will.

God, take away my reservations that I am powerless over my addiction and that my life is unmanageable if I run it. Do this by filling me with honesty with myself and others. God,

may I always let you do this one day at a time. God, help me to knock down the walls which I have put up, so that I may let the God in me shine through and be beautiful; and let the God in me help others, love others, and serve others by your grace. God, I pray that I may have faith's look, the spiritual eye. I pray that by faith I may open the box of time and space with my imagination, which you gave me, and look beyond the now to eternal life.

As a result of working the twelve steps, regularly attending meeting and practicing these principles in all of our affairs to the best of our ability and on a daily basis, a spiritual awakening happened in our lives. God consciousness fills the empty place inside that nothing ever could before and we know a true peace and a true happiness. We come to handle instinctively problems and circumstances which used to baffle us and we come to dwell in the fullness and abundance as a direct result of having worked the Twelve Steps and maintaining our spiritual condition. We find it nesessary to continue to dos so on a daily basis.

#9-5

Concious contact with the higher power of our understanding is the achievement of awareness on the spiritual level coupled with a patience, and tolerance and humility. Some of us have experienced these things in part while using drugs.-The distinction comes from our being able to use this gift to help others and become useful and productive ourselves. Vision without means is a curse. Percieving greater ends without being able to participate or play any role leaves us feeling lft out. We want to change all that. Whatever contact we have achieved, we want to improve and refine. Prayer and meditation are the primary means to acheiving this end.

9-J

It has not always been easy for me to work the Twelve Steps as I was one of those hard heads, but I know now that Nar-Anon has become a whole new way of life for me and the program is something that I never want to lose. I no longer feel alone, I found a partner in my Higher Power, whom I choose to call God, Who is at my side in all things, if I will just cease trying to control and will surrender to His will. His way is always better than mine, but for a long time I had lost God. Gradually as I became more God-centered instead of self-centered, my despair has turned to hope, self pity and resentments have been replaced by tolerance, and faith has replaced my fears and anxieties. Patience, humility and gratitude now have a place in my life.

Our program recommends that learning to live begins with learning to take things a day at a time. Many of us practice some form of morning meditation and include material of a spiritual nature that reminds us of our disease and offers different points of view which revitalize our living. We suggest you find what works for you.

The principles of surrender, admission of fault, improving belief, prayer and meditation guide us into a way of life in which our total resources, centered in God as we understand God, become available to us.

#9-5

(30)

SUPER ME

I was super-critical, super hostile and super negative. I didn't always voice these opinions but would think them and hang on to them inside. I always had faith but lost it over a period of years, unaware of what was happening to me and always filled with guilt, unhappiness and discontent and being completely dependent on others for my happiness. I knew my life had turned sour and blamed other people and seemed powerless to turn the tide. I reacted to every word said or deed done. I was continually feeling good or bad depending on the behavior of others. Mostly bad, because my attitude refused to see any good at all. I never had time to find fault with myself because I was busy watching, guiding, and controlling someone else. Everyone was out of step but me.

After the first meeting I found my God was not dead - - I was, spiritually. I accepted the Steps readily. I found the peace and serenity they promise. Each day is filled with the joy of living. Old habits are hard to break and sometimes unknowingly I will let them slip in, but now I have a way to check them before they consume me and leave me devastated as they did before. I find that a good share of my problems are because of my reactions. I no longer take on other people's feelings. I am not always successful in this but I am aware of what is happening and can release it. I know my happiness lies only within myself, just as I cannot accept the responsibility for the actions or happiness of another individual no matter how close they are to me. I look forward to each new day with joy and hope knowing that it is my day and only I can appreciate it. I start each day with an awareness of God, asking for His guidance and the wisdom to accept it, and the strength and courage to accept whatever the day holds for me. Each day I grown. As my faith strengthens, my fears grow weaker and vanish. Faith and fear cannot live side by side. At night I thank God for the joy of the day, the serenity He has given me, and ask His forgiveness for any unhappiness I have caused another. I have total acceptance and surrender in my loving God and I pray that I can be of help to others.

9-5

#9-K SERVICE SELFLESS

To me, the program is taking someone I detest to a meeting; going to help someone I wish harm to; letting someone sanctimonious sit next to me in a meeting; listening to people I do not identify with; staying in a meeting with people I don't approve of talking.

Spirituality & willingness are theoretical until tested--useless till used.

God removes our defects not us--we only have the right to approve a choice before he does it. He gives us an estimate, we sign & the price is usually greater than quoted.

With your sensitivity and sympathy, and your power of understanding, you can breathe life into me. I want you to know that.

I want you to know how important you are to me, how you can be a creator of the person that is me if you choose to.

You alone can break down the wall behind which I tremble, you alone can remove my mask,

you alone can release me from my shadow-world of panic and uncertainty, from my lonely prison.

We continue making plenty of meetings throughout all phases of our recovery. We also as part of our spiritual maintainence take a part in active service. Some of us find becoming active in service work provides us with a way to be of help in providing for the needs of our groups and membership, which cannot be met by individual members. We find service work an experience in putting principles before personalities, and a growing and learning where we strive to put into practice the principles and traditions of our program. Most of us who have become involved have found that unselfish service to the program returns more to us than we give.

0056

#4-K SERVICE SELFLESS

TO SEE.

FOR MYSELF I KNOW I CANT FOOL MYSELF TO HARD TO FAST BUT I CAN SAY THAT I AM WILLING TO TRY TO GO TO ANY LENGTHS TO "GET IT" THIS TIME. EVEN IF IT MEANS BEING CLEAN AND SOBER TO DO SO. I FEEL THAT THE ONLY WAY THAT I'M GOING TO GET ANY BETTER. THANKS AGAIN FOR ALL THAT YOU HAVE DONE FOR ME, MAYBE I'LL GET THE CHANCE TO DO IT FOR SOMEONE ELSE.

WITH MY BROTHERLY LOVE,

JOHN

Helping with the functions of the meetings adds to our recovery by giving us something tangible we can do to be of help. Helping to build the service structure in an area is basically only an extension of coffee chairman type duties. Many of us find personal service very rewarding in spiritual terms. Personal service is taking an active interest in the recovery of another addict, either one-on-one or at a group level and contributes to our own recovery.

0078

orientation meeting
2 hrs. apart
30-45 minutes duration
stay opened a couple
hrs. after orientation

Put up topic poster.

Talk to Dwight about
ribbons with Hope

9-L Wisdom

Faith is an inward certainty of God beyond words and beyond measure. True Knowledge can only be of God, not worldly things, because worldly things pass away. God doesn't.

God is frightening from afar, but the closer you get the more friendly he is and beautiful and loving – your only true friend all along.

the man who puts his faith in worldly things like sex, cars, money, drugs and nice houses, He dies and they all go away but when a man who puts his faith in God dies he has God after death. that is the beauty of faith in God.

As long as my heart aspires to grow in the all illumined all fulfilling Supreme (God) my Higher power. As long as I am an aspirant and accept it and act accordingly then I will be all right then I then I will grow and care and serve and love.

#9 L Wisdom

IONS

...ave to give love in order to get it.

To looks beyond material things is within the power of everyone's imagination, by the grace of God. This is Faith's look, the spiritual eye. Faith's look saves you from despair, from worry and care. Faith's look brings you a peace beyond all understanding. It brings you all the strength you need to do God's will. Faith's look gives you a new and vital power (Knowledge) and a wonderful peace and serenity.

Man's thoughts are adequate, not perfect, but by the grace of God they are adequate; and that is beautiful. Some things are more adequate than others as you go along. Things get more adequate as you grow and serve and love and care. — things get better. Pray for more adequacy and meditate on things and be grateful for the adequacy you have and for the glimmers of perfection, which is beautiful. No religion or philosophy is perfect, just adequate, because it is thought of by humans, who can think only adequately. People do have glimmers of perfection, of God who is perfect, and that is beautiful. Only religions thought of by God are perfect; since Jesus is God, Christianity as taught by Jesus is perfect. We can strive through prayer in this area.

(for progress)D

9-V

At one time or another during our addiction most of us have been in a very desperate situation and experienced a state where we were able to survive by quickly doing and saying the right thing until the danger passed. Many of us tried to maintain this feeling of adequacy and failed. The same inner force that saved our lives on so many occassions becomes available to us in our recovery. We learn how to bring out this inner force many of us call God and to apply it in our daily lives. Our twelve steps guide us into contact with this spiritual force and it meets all our needs.

Acceptance can be difficult to understand. Most of us want and dema things for our way. I sometimes refuse to accept. Acceptance is a big word with alot of meaning. When I accept what cannot be changed I feel that I am facing reality and realizing what the situation is all about.

I need this program more than it needs me and this is where I belong.

The things that have boosted my self esteem have been meetings with people who have the same desease

#9 m Serenity

We begin to see how only the higher power, greater than ourselves restores us to sanity from the compulsion to use drugs and run not in life.

We gradually turn our will and our life over to the complete care of the higher power's constant guidance.

I will greet this day with love in my heart.

For this is the greatest secret of success in all ventures. Muscle can split a shield and even destroy life but only the unseen power of love can open the hearts of men and until I master this art I will remain no more than a peddler in the market place. I will make love my greatest weapon and none on whom I call can defend against its force.

My reasoning they may counter; my speech they may distrust; my apparel they may disaprove; my face they may reject; and even my bargains may cause them suspicion; yet my love will melt all hearts liken to the sun whose rays soften the coldest clay.

I will greet this day with love in my heart.

And how will I do this? Henceforth will I look on all things with love and I will be born again. I will love the sun for it warms my bones; yet I will love the rain for it cleanses my spirit. I will love the light for it shows me the way; yet I will love the darkness for it shows me the stars. I will welcome happiness for it enlarges my heart; yet I will endure sadness for it opens my soul. I will acknowledge rewards for they are my due; yet I will welcome obstacles for they are my challenge.

I will greet this day with love in my heart.

And how will I speak? I will laud mine enemies and they will become friends; I will encourage my friends and they will become brothers. Always will I dig for reasons to applaud; never will I scratch for excuses to gossip. When I am tempted to criticize I will bite on my tongue; when I am moved to praise I will shout from the roofs.

Is it not so that birds, the wind, the sea and all nature speaks with the music of praise for their creator? Cannot I speak with the same music to his children? Henceforth will I remember this secret and it will change my life.

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I will greet this day with love in my heart.

#9 - m Serenity

(37)

Sometimes, today, I wake up & don't know who I am. (I never know which personality I am), but I am so changed, I go into shock. Waking up by impending doom once made alarm clocks unnecessary. Now it takes 10-minutes for the clock to wake me. The crazy people living in my skull whisper nasty things at me frequently. There used to be 20 voices screaming full volume constantly (on a good day).

Some people even know where I live now & to a few I even tell what's really going on inside. Once, if I knew that was already too many. It's hard to trust people while you (they?) are still prone to plotting to poison you. For me to take 3-minutes out to help someone else (when I'm in the mood to do something else) is a spiritual miracle.

Serenity - a reflection of hope for Peace and serenity this season and always

Hank had been buying gasoline at the same filling station for years. The man in charge of the station was always surly and rude, but whenever Hank bought his gas there, he wished the man a good day. Amazed, a friend commented to Hank one day, "How can you be so friendly to such a negative person?" "Because", said Hank, "I just couldn't let someone like that determine my r reaction."

Sometimes I hear people saying that they are serene and know everything there is to know about themselves. That attitude can be defeating in its own way. When assuming things like this peacefulness can be mislead within oneself. 0/01

When we feel others have wronged us, we shouldn't be surprised if we feel overwhelmed by the emotions. Gone are the chemical mood changers. With help we can learn to take our reality clean. We should remember that we are powerless to change other people. If we are willing to take a closer look, we can find ways we could have handled things better. By surrendering our resentment to a Power, greater than ourselves, and asking It to hebdle our porblems for us we can relieve a lot of our pain and torment. Whenever we hold on to a resentment, we are letting that person have space in our heads rent free. We waste our time and our energy trying to think of ways to get back at the other person. The program doesn't reccomend that we play

Instead of days good or bad, gratitude simply says, "Thanks for the day. This day Clean is better than any day using. Clean living is best."

F9-W Learning

(38)

The more situations that arise and the more incidents that occur the more I learn. I cannot be a teacher all the time. I feel that learning is more important. I can only learn through experience. If I can learn this way then I can grow. Growth and learning about whether things can or cannot be changed is very important to me.

0101

Realizing our resentments can be fatal, we should take them seriously and go out of our way if necessary to learn to use the tools of the program of Narcotics Anonymous to learn to deal with them. Through the Program we have learned to use our Higher Power to get us out of our traps and into the flow of life. Many members let themselves down by postponing the use of spiritual principles feeling that they are not relevant to daily living problems. Many living problems never get better untill we learn to apply spiritual principles.

#9-0 Daily Reprieve Based on practical spirituality

39

with out my H.P. I cant experience any compassion. (for myself or others.

... I knew my life had become unmanageable but I had not been able to admit that I was powerless over the addict. At this first meeting it was like a big weight was lifted from me - guilt feelings rolled off and a feeling of peace came over me as I realized that with my surrender to my Higher Power would come the help I so desperately wanted. I also felt the great feeling of warmth and love that came from the Group, and for the first time in many months I relaxed as I heard that I couldn't control my addict. 9-0

In the first stages of our active withdrawal from drugs we used meetings, new friends, sponsors to help us learn to feel good and deal with daily events without returning to drugs. We learn the importance of living only one day at a time. We don't have to make a commitment to stay clean for the rest of our lives. We only have to make this decision for one twenty-four hours. Meetings remain for us all, the primary source of our recovery.

These are guidelines and suggestions. We have found they work for us. This is how we maintain our spiritual condition. For us, this finally fills the empty place. We never have to be lonely ever again. Our Higher Power is accessible at all times, night or day, and in the fellowship of NA we have more friends than we ever believed we could. Finally, we are fulfilled, unlonely and come to know a real peace and a true sence of self worth.

Pain si inevitable in this world . Human beings have to learn to live in this world . Basically when Im hurtin Gods tryin to give me something and I wont take it. 9-0

#9-0 Daily reprieve based on practical Spirituality

********** MY SPIRITUAL AWAKENING ********** by Cindy B.

Recently I had the opportunity to go to a retreat for addicted people. For weeks before I felt a need to improve my conscious contact with my Higher Power, who I now accept as my God. I had a lot of confusion about faith versus religion. I went there with this in mind, and finally after much discussion and meetings, I learned how to just 'turn it over', something I thought I had been doing. Now I finally accept God as mine and know that He accepts me. Previous to this I thought I was unworthy of His love. It is only through the program that I became aware of my God and learned to accept myself for what I am, and forgive myself for my past. For this I am grateful.

********** SPEAKING COMMITTEE **********

" Do we each alone in our own way have a unique spiritual experience and spiritual awakening; or is there a common shared element to how we come to believe in a Higher Power; to believe that He is working in our lives; and that, that leap into the unknown, Faith, where we personally come to believe and to trust in our own Higher Power, not just as in the Third Step of Narcotics Anonymous, "We made a decision to turn our will and our lives over to the care of God as we understand Him", but having been able to have the faith to do it. How do we than maintain this spiritual condition?"

He said he felt that we each of us alone and at different times have this spiritual awakening. Just as we were unique in some respects and aspects of our misery using, so there is a personal aspect to each one's spiritual awakening and experience. We each have a personal concept of who and what our Higher Power is.

He went on to add that for himself the spiritual part of the program was the entire program. It included going to meetings even when he didn't want to, reaching out to others, daily meditation, picking up coffee cups and ash trays after a meeting, serving as a trusted servant and working each of the Twelve Steps and as a result of having done so, practicing these principles in all of his affairs.

He said that today he has a lot to be grateful for, but often when things don't work out instead of blaming it on God, he sees it is usually a direct result of his own self-will and defects getting in his way and mucking up the works.

#9-0 Daily reprieve based on practical spirituality

(24)

I'M SURE MY SELF CENTEREDNESS COULD RUN MUCH DEEPER, BY THE GRACE OF GOD IT DOESN'T. 0160

THE PLAGUE OF MY HUMANITY SEEMS TO BE NO SOONER THAN ~~EMEDIATE~~ IMEDIATELY AFTER A HUMBLING EXPERIENCE I AM READY TO GO OUT AND PROVE HOW GREAT I AM. TODAY HOWEVER IT IS MUCH EASIER TO GIVE CREDIT WERE CREDITS DUE, AND RECONIZE WHEN CREDITS DUE.

WHEN I CAME TO THE PROGRAM TO BE HUMBLE MEANT TO RIDE IN THE BACK SEAT AND OPEN THE DOOR FOR THE OTHER PERSON. HUMILITY WAS DEFEAT IN THE FACE OF NOT TO OVERWHELMING ODDS AND A HUMBLE MAN WAS A FRAIR IN BLACK WHO CONTINOUSLY WALKED WITH HIS HEAD BOWED.

TODAY HUMILITY IS RECONIZING WHO I AM, A VERY POWERLESS & UNMANAGABLE DRUG ADDICT WHO CAN ASK FOR HELP.

A LOT OF MY PRIDE IS GONE, I DONT HAVE TO HOLD MY HEAD UP AND CRY TO THE WORLD LOOK AT HOW GREAT I AM! I CAN LOOK AT MY FELLOWS IN THE EYE AND NOT ~~FOR~~ UP ~~WALLOW~~ FROM MY WALLOWING HOLE. I CAN REACH OUT MY HAND TO THOSE STILL SUFFERING (ME TOO!) AND OPEN MY MOUTH AND ASK FOR HELP. TODAY ITS OK TO NEED ~~FOR~~ YOUR FRIENDSHIP & LOVE & OK TO GIVE SOME BACK. ITS NO LONGER A ONE WAY STREET, YOU GIVE & I'LL TAKE, I HAVE SOMETHING TO GIVE TOO!

GOD BLESS!!

#9-0 Daily reprieve based on practical spirituality

(42)

He stressed that going to meetings, workingthe Twelve Steps and practising these principles in his life, remembering to ask God for help in the morning and to thank Him at night, only worked for one day. That the next morning he couldn't get up and say," well, I did all these things yesterday. I don't have to do them again today." Rather, that he had a continuing and progressive illness and that he is granted only a daily reprieve from the effects of his active addiction.

That on those days he doesn't work the steps, go to meetings etc. he doesn't have a good day. Sometimes after a few days of not doing anything to maintain his spiritual condition he has a really lousy ddy and things are really starting to get out of hand. This is when pain motivates him to recommence daily Spiritual maintenance or his friends and sponsors see he is in pain and ask what he is doing today to maintain his spiritual condition.

Sometimes, he said, he sees his Higher Power working through other people that sometimes when an old-timer gets away from the steps, daily prayer and meditiation, and isn't working the program to the best of his ability on a daily basis, that other members see that old-timer hurting. Just as the newcomer is the most important person at any meeting, the old-timer who is hurting, is like that new-comer, the person it is most important we reach out to.